Berk Filcan

PhD. Student

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Education

2023–Current **University of Texas at Austin**, Austin, United States.
PhD. in Political Science

2021–2023 **Sabancı University**, İstanbul, Turkey.
M.A. in Political Science,
M.A. Thesis Title: "The Electoral Consequences of Historical Cleavages and Migration: A Geographic Discontinuity Approach"

2017–2021 **Boğaziçi University**, İstanbul, Turkey.
B.A. in Political Science and International Relations, double major with Economics.

2015–2017 **Boğaziçi University**, İstanbul, Turkey.
B.Sc. in Chemical Engineering.

2010-2015 **Galatasaray High School**, İstanbul, Turkey.

Teaching and Research Experience

Fall 2026 **Teaching Assistant**, *GOV324L: Govt. and Pols. of Western Europe*, UT Austin.
Graded exams and response papers, held regular office hours.

Spring 2026 **Teaching Assistant**, *GOV312L: Issues and Policies in American Govt.*, UT Austin.
Graded exams and response papers, held regular office hours.

Fall 2025 **Teaching Assistant**, *GOV365V: The Comprehensive Notion of European Security*, UT Austin.
Graded exams and response papers, held regular office hours.

Spring 2023 **Teaching Assistant**, *GOV312L: Issues and Policies in American Govt.*, UT Austin.
Graded exams and response papers, held regular office hours.

Fall 2023 **Teaching Assistant**, *GOV324L: Govt. and Pols. of Western Europe*, UT Austin.
Graded exams and response papers, held regular office hours.

2021-2023 **Teaching Assistant**, *SPS102: Humanity and Society*, Sabancı University.
Prepared and led weekly discussion sessions for the freshman undergraduate course, graded exams and response papers, held regular office hours.

Fall 2020 **Teaching Assistant**, *POLS203: Social Statistics*, Boğaziçi University.
Prepared and led weekly sessions on R for the undergraduate statistics course.

Spring 2020 **Teaching Assistant**, *CMPE140: Intro. to Computing for Economists*, Boğaziçi University.
An introductory data science course based on R, attended problem sessions and prepared the material for these sessions and quizzes.

Fall 2019 **Teaching Assistant**, *POLS303: Fundamentals of Political Economy*, Boğaziçi University.
Prepared and led weekly discussion sessions.

Summer 2019 **Research Assistant**, *Department of Political Science*, Boğaziçi University.
Undergraduate summer research assistant for two projects, conducted by Prof. Mine Eder and Prof. Özlem Öz, and Assoc. Prof. Zeynep Kadirbeyoğlu.

Fall 2018 **Teaching Assistant**, *POLS101: Intro. to Political Science*, Boğaziçi University.
Prepared and led weekly discussion sessions.

Research Interests

Party politics, electoral behavior, electoral campaigns, European politics, political methodology, computational social science.

Conference Presentations

April 2024 **82nd Midwest Political Science Association Annual Meeting Exhibition**
Presented the paper *Blinding Lights: Local Muslim Population and Far-Right Vote in Germany*, focusing on the effect of immigration on far-right parties applying contact theory using geospatial analysis with satellite data.

Sep 2020 **20th American Political Science Association Annual Meeting Exhibition**
Presented a Network Theory application workshop based on R, chaired by Asst. Prof. Başak Taraktas.

Professional Experience

2022 **Junior Data Scientist**, *Vitamu*, İstanbul-New York.
Junior data scientist in the AI team; helped develop deep learning models based on PyTorch libraries to detect breast cancer.

2020 **Community Manager Assistant**, *inzva*, İstanbul.
Helped expand quality and size of the inzva community, a hackerspace where programming enthusiasts meet in the fields of algorithm and artificial intelligence.

Awards and Scholarships

2024 **Rapoport Fellowship**, *The University of Texas*
Research fellowship focusing on political behavior.

2023-2029 **Littlefield Fellowship**, *The University of Texas*
Ph.D. scholarship with full tuition, stipend support and exemption from teaching duties for two years.

2021-2023 **Full Scholarship**, *Sabancı University.*
M.A. scholarship with full tuition and stipend support.

2017-2021 **TEV Outstanding Success Scholarship**, *Turkish Education Foundation (TEV)*
Given to students with "a strong personality, strong national values, reliable personality, and leadership skills" along with outstanding academic success in undergraduate programs and the nationwide university entrance exam.

2015-2021 **KYK Government Merit-Based Scholarship**, *Turkish Republic Ministry of Education*
Given to students ranked top 100 in the national university entrance exam, out of nearly 2 million students (Ranked 98th).

Skills

Languages Turkish (native), English (advanced), French (advanced), Ottoman Turkish (reading fluency), German (beginner), Latin (beginner).

Software R, Stata, Python.